WON SUK (WAYNE) LEE

Seoul, Republic of Korea · ycbc0501@gmail.com · +82 10-4176-1990

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Baekdu Technologies Inc. — *Founder & CEO* **2020 – Present / Seoul, Korea**

Company behind Aark Digital, a decentralized derivatives exchange, and earlier a DeFi fund; backed by 18 institutional investors across six markets.

Aark Digital **2022 – Present**

- Secured $10M entirely through cold outreach with no prior connections, from Delphi Digital, Arrington Capital, OKX Ventures, CRIT (Com2uS's venture arm) and HashKey Capital—one of Korea's five largest crypto raises from international investors to date.
- Scaled the exchange from zero to $100B+ cumulative volume across 32,000+ traders, third-largest by 2024 volume on Arbitrum (per DefiLlama), a top-two blockchain for derivatives; smart contracts audited by Hacken, Secure3 and Pashov; built a 20-person team in four countries.
- Launched FX and stock derivatives alongside crypto, which drew protocol partnerships, two leading institutional market makers, selection as the Abstract Foundation's official derivatives exchange (SpeedTrading), and one of the Arbitrum Foundation's largest grants (900,000 ARB).
- Led the response to a $1.8M security breach (Oct 2024) with Binance's security team, forensic firms and law enforcement: briefed every investor within two hours and delivered a full report within six; had the responsible engineer brief investors on root causes rather than dismissing him, and instituted mandatory peer review; took two acquisition offers through diligence to protect investors; volume recovered to $100M/day in a month.
- Restructured after the breach: cut burn ~50% and the team from 20 to ten, who stayed until mid-2026, on half salary from late 2025; then let the team go and moved to one employee supported by AI tooling; the exchange runs profitably today at ~$20M/day.

DeFi Fund **2020 – 2022**

- Raised a $15M digital-asset fund from Korea's leading crypto institutions (Hyperithm, Heybit, Blocore, among others) and select high-net-worth individuals, with company-level backing from Mirae Asset Venture Investment; designed a strategy exploiting price gaps between exchanges that returned up to ~350% for founding investors, run under ISO/IEC 27001-certified security.
- Repaid investors in full after the May 2022 Terra-Luna collapse halved the fund: recovered $5M through arbitrage trading over the following two days and covered the remaining $2M personally, though force majeure released the company from liability; replaced monthly reports with live investor dashboards on every metric.
- Convened 800+ people with Ledger, a hardware-wallet maker, at Korea Blockchain Week 2022, Ledger's first Korean event at that scale, bringing traditional-finance allocators, exchanges, policymakers and Korea Blockchain Cooperative member firms into one room.

Coinone — *Business Development Lead* **2018 – 2020 / Seoul, Korea**

One of Korea's leading licensed cryptocurrency exchanges, backed by OKX, Com2uS and Korea Investment & Securities.

- Built the overseas exchange business from zero: secured a US liquidity partner (Cumberland) and an EU-jurisdiction digital-asset license in Malta; grew institutional trading from low single digits to 15% of total volume.
- Ran Series B investor communications and diligence ($110M valuation) as the CEO's sole partner on the Hong Kong roadshow.

Shinhan BNP Paribas Asset Management — *Equity Fund Manager* **2016 – 2018 / Seoul, Korea**

One of Korea's largest asset managers, a Shinhan Financial Group–BNP Paribas JV (now Shinhan Asset Management).

- Youngest fund manager in the firm's history; managed a book within a ~$400M fund that ranked #1 among Korea's large equity funds in 1H 2016, on early calls in semiconductor materials and equipment and energy/petrochemicals.
- Authored 113 sector and company research reports and presented sector calls and updates directly to the CEO and the BNP Paribas-appointed vice president at monthly board meetings.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Korea Blockchain Cooperative — Senior Member, Policy Contributor (2021–Present): Korea's only statutory body for the blockchain sector. Helped turn the Virtual Asset User Protection Act's custody and investor-protection rules into guidance operators could implement; contributed to proposals carried to the Prime Minister's 2026 regulatory-reform forum; co-organized the National Assembly's first RWA-legislation seminar (Sept 2026) with Ripple, Ondo and the Financial Supervisory Service.

CFA Institute Research Challenge, Korea — Team Leader (2016): 1st place for a 180-page report on Asian commodities and luxury companies.

Real Investment Society of Korea — Head of Proprietary Fund (2013–2015), first investment leadership role: 9.9% return vs. KOSPI −4.9%.

ROK Army — Defense Security Command, Squad Leader / English Interpreter (2011–2013): interpreted at the 2012 Nuclear Security Summit.

EDUCATION

Korea University — B.A., International Studies (taught in English) | GPA 4.02/4.50 | Scholarship Honors (2013) **2009 – 2016 / Seoul, Korea**

ADDITIONAL

Languages	Korean and English (bilingual), Chinese (HSK 4)
Background	Raised across diplomatic postings; 10 years of international school in US (VA, NJ), Vietnam and Korea (Cheongshim Int'l Academy)
Activities	Founders' Talk founding member (founder mental-health group, since 2021); Seongnam disability association volunteer (2017–2020)
Interests	Tennis (weekday organizer, Gangnam Tennis Club); Baseball (former left fielder); Korea University B-boy crew (former leader)